James Gunn Gives a Fan's DC Timeline a Thumbs-Up -- Almost

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Keeping track of the DC Universe just got a little easier, thanks to a fan. A user called comicbookcollide posted a list of DC films and TV shows on **Threads**, arranging them into a **timeline** of events inside the story world. DC Studios co-head James Gunn replied, "**Timelines** give me anxiety, but I think this is pretty good." It is about as strong a thumbs-up as a fan **timeline** can get, though Gunn stopped short of calling it fully official. The **timeline** places the new film "Clayface" as the second DC Universe project, with its events set in 2021. It also includes "Blue Beetle," the 2023 film that originally belonged to the older DC Extended Universe. Gunn has confirmed that "Blue Beetle" counts as part of the new DC Universe, and the **timeline** puts its events in 2023, just before "Creature Commandos" Season 1, the official first DC Universe project. That also places "Blue Beetle" after "Clayface," "The Suicide Squad" and "Peacemaker" Season 1, and before "Superman." Gunn has been careful not to endorse the **timeline** as completely accurate. He has said that "Blue Beetle" needs a few small changes, called **retcons**, to fit into the new universe, and the same is true of "Peacemaker" Season 1, whose finale was **re-edited** to show the **Justice Gang** instead of the former Justice League. The **timeline** also leaves out some events, such as "Lanterns" Episode 1, which showed that Earth's first Lantern, Hal Jordan, appeared in 1986 and revealed his identity in 1996, long before the events of "Superman," set in 2025. The Wrap previously reported that Blue Beetle actor Xolo Maridueña is set to appear in Gunn's "Superman" **sequel**, "Man of Tomorrow," which would firm up the film's place in the new universe.

Word Treasure

retcons -- A retcon is a small change to a story so it fits with newer stories.
timeline -- A timeline is a list of events in the order they happened.
Threads -- Threads is a social media app for sharing short posts.
re-edited -- Re-edited means changed after the first version was made.
Justice Gang -- The Justice Gang is a group of heroes in the DC Universe.
sequel -- A sequel is a movie that continues an earlier movie's story.

Background you need

DC is a company that makes superhero movies and TV shows, including Superman and Batman.

A shared universe is a set of movies and shows whose stories connect with each other.

A timeline lists events in the order they happen in the story world.

Fans often debate how the stories fit together, and the people who run the studio sometimes join in.

Break it down

LEAD: A fan's DC timeline wins praise from James Gunn
KEY EVENT: Gunn calls the timeline "pretty good" on Threads
+- WHO: comicbookcollide, James Gunn and Xolo Maridueña
+- WHAT: A timeline of DC films and shows in story order
+- WHY: Fans want to know how the stories fit together
EVIDENCE: Clayface set in 2021, Blue Beetle in 2023 before Creature Commandos
OPEN QUESTION: Will "Man of Tomorrow" settle Blue Beetle's place in the DC Universe?

Why it matters

Superhero movies are more fun when the stories fit together, and fans love helping to map the universe.

Test what you remember

1. Who posted the DC timeline?

- (A) James Gunn
- (B) The Wrap
- (C) A fan called comicbookcollide
- (D) Xolo Maridueña

2. Where was the timeline posted?

- (A) On Instagram
- (B) On YouTube
- (C) On Threads
- (D) On TikTok

3. What did James Gunn say about the timeline?

- (A) He said nothing at all
- (B) This timeline is completely wrong
- (C) Timelines give me anxiety, but I think this is pretty good
- (D) This timeline is 100% official

4. In what year are the events of "Clayface" set in the timeline?

- (A) 2021
- (B) 2025
- (C) 2023
- (D) 2019

5. Which project is the official first DC Universe project?

- (A) Peacemaker Season 1
- (B) Blue Beetle
- (C) Creature Commandos Season 1
- (D) Superman

6. What is "Man of Tomorrow"?

- (A) Gunn's Superman sequel
- (B) A comic book series
- (C) A new Batman movie
- (D) A DC video game

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: C 3: C 4: A 5: C 6: A

Questions to think about

1. James Gunn: says the fan timeline is pretty good but stops short of calling it fully official

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):